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Democracy Dies in Darkness

WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 19, 2025 • **\$4**

Congress set to send Epstein bill to Trump

Motion passes after months-long crusade to release investigation files

BY KADIA GOBA,
AMY B WANG
AND THEODORIC MEYER

Congress was poised Tuesday to send a bill to President Donald Trump to force the Justice Department to release files related to deceased sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, overcoming a months-long impasse in the House and quickly dispatching with the issue in the Senate.

Hours after the bill passed the House on a 427-1 vote, the Senate agreed to deem the legislation passed as soon as it arrives from the House. Senate Minority Leader Charles E. Schumer (D-New York) offered a motion that received unanimous consent and will require no further action by the chamber.

The House vote was the remarkable culmination of a bipartisan crusade by Reps. Thomas Massie (R-Kentucky) and Ro Khanna (D-California) that until Sunday had met fierce resistance from Trump, who repeatedly insisted that the focus on the Epstein files was a “hoax” promoted by Democrats.

House Speaker Mike Johnson (R-Louisiana) said he had asked Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R-South Dakota) to amend the bill — which Johnson called a “political stunt” by Democrats — to include additional protections for Epstein victims

SEE EPSTEIN ON A8

Cracks in the base: Growing fissures spur GOP concerns. **A4**

Parts of Education Dept. to be dismantled

Trump administration plans to move key offices to other federal agencies

BY LAURA MECKLER AND
DANIELLE DOUGLAS-GABRIEL

The Education Department said Tuesday that it will move several of its offices to other federal departments, a unilateral effort aimed at dismantling an agency created by Congress to ensure equal access to educational opportunity but long derided by conservatives as ineffective.

The department has signed interagency agreements to outsource six offices to other agencies, including those that administer \$28 billion in grants to K-12 schools and \$3.1 billion for programs that help students finish college.

There was considerable speculation that the \$15 billion program to support students with disabilities would be included in the announcement, but it was not. Other major functions of the Education Department, including its Office for Civil Rights and the federal student aid program, also were not affected by Tuesday’s changes, but a senior

SEE EDUCATION ON A5



DEMETRIUS FREEMAN/THE WASHINGTON POST

President Donald Trump hosts Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman on Tuesday. The CIA in 2018 concluded Mohammed approved Washington Post opinion columnist Jamal Khashoggi’s killing.

Trump defends Saudi prince over journalist’s killing

U.S. TIES WITH KINGDOM REACH HIGH POINT

Pomp-filled arrival for leader once branded a pariah

BY MICHAEL BIRNBAUM,
NATALIE ALLISON
AND SUSANNAH GEORGE

President Donald Trump on Tuesday defended Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman over the killing of Washington Post opinion columnist Jamal Khashoggi, saying “things happen” and that he did not hold the Saudi leader responsible for the 2018 murder despite a U.S. intelligence report assessing the opposite.

Trump’s dismissive language offered the highest-level confirmation yet that Mohammed will face few consequences for the killing, as the crown prince makes his first visit to Washington since Khashoggi was dismembered in a Saudi consulate in Turkey.

“A lot of people didn’t like that gentleman that you’re talking about. Whether you like him or didn’t like him, things happen, but [Mohammed] knew nothing about it,” Trump said in response to a question about Khashoggi. “And we can leave it at that. You don’t have to embarrass our guest by asking a question like that.”

Mohammed arrived to a grand welcome from Trump at the White House on Tuesday, greeted at the South Portico with an Army honor guard of black horses and herald trumpeters, a remarkable turnaround for the de facto ruler of Saudi Arabia who had been branded a pariah in 2018 after the CIA concluded that he had approved the killing of Khashoggi.

“Pariahs shouldn’t get to visit the White House,” said Jason

Rezaian, The Washington Post’s director of press freedom initiatives. “It’s a mistake to reward the most abhorrent abuses of power.”

As early as his first term, Trump declared his desire to move past the killing and protect Mohammed from congressional demands for consequences. More recently, Trump’s son-in-law, Jared Kushner, has taken Saudi investments in his business projects, and Trump’s family business has announced numerous new business projects this year with Saudi partners who have ties to the royal family.

Trump said Tuesday that he has “nothing to do with the family business,” and the organization “does business all over.”

“They’ve done very little with Saudi Arabia, actually,” Trump said. “I’m sure they could do a lot.”

Trump’s embrace of the crown prince despite U.S. intelligence warnings of his complicity in Khashoggi’s murder recalled a similar moment in Trump’s first term, when he said he took Russian President Vladimir Putin’s vow over a U.S. intelligence assessment that the Kremlin interfered in the 2016 elections.

Trump offered a chummy welcome to Mohammed in the Oval Office on Tuesday, grasping his hand and wrist while mocking former president Joe Biden for offering a fist bump to the crown prince in 2022 because he did not want to extend the courtesy of a

SEE SAUDI ON A12

A volatile decade: Key moments in the U.S.-Saudi relationship. **A12**

Key Bridge deaths could have been prevented, NTSB finds

BY KATIE METTLER
AND MICHAEL LARIS

Had they been alerted, the six workers who died in the Francis Scott Key Bridge collapse would have had about one minute and 29 seconds to escape, potentially enough time to save their lives, federal investigators said Tuesday.

But police officers with the

Maryland Transportation Authority who were stationed at the end of the Baltimore bridge to help keep the workers safe did not call the construction team inspector to warn him that the massive container ship Dali was veering toward one of the support pillars after it had lost power, the National Transportation Safety Board reported during a hearing in D.C. on

SEE BRIDGE ON A6

In defeat for FTC, judge rules Meta is not illegal monopoly

BY NAOMI NIX

A federal judge has rejected the Federal Trade Commission’s effort to force Meta to divest its acquisitions of Instagram and WhatsApp, saying the government hadn’t made its case that the Facebook owner is an illegal monopoly.

In his ruling Tuesday, U.S. District Judge James E. Boasberg

in D.C. agreed with Meta that its purchases of the photo-sharing app Instagram and messaging app WhatsApp, which it bought in 2012 and 2014, respectively, did not violate antitrust laws.

Boasberg found that the social media company isn’t a monopoly and faces a broad internet ecosystem of competitors rather than the far narrower one the

SEE META ON A7

Boomers’ vast wealth will be hard to replicate

Favorable economic conditions meant group could prioritize saving

BY SHANNON NAJMABADI
AND FEDERICA COCCO

Baby boomers hold more than \$85 trillion in assets, making them the richest generation by far. New research explores the extraordinary rise in their good fortunes — one that experts say successive generations will be hard-pressed to replicate.

The reasons come down to timing and time: Americans 75 and older bought homes and invested in stocks well before such assets exploded in value, according to Edward Wolff, an economics professor at New York University. In a working paper for the National Bureau of Economic Research, he examined the four decades between 1983 and 2022 when those older boomers saw their wealth climb and their younger peers recorded relative declines.

“It’s astonishing how their relative wealth has taken off in the last 30-plus years,” Wolff said. “They started out as among the poorest groups in terms of wealth back in 1983.”

The wealth of baby boomers — especially those in retirement —

SEE BOOMER ON A15



JOHN MOORE/GETTY IMAGES

Mass immigration arrests in Charlotte meet with resistance

Students at East Mecklenburg High School in Charlotte walk out on Tuesday in protest of operations targeting undocumented immigrants. The Department of Homeland Security announced more than 130 arrests in the first two days of the raids. **Story, A2**

IN THE NEWS

Texas map blocked A federal court halted a push by Republicans to enact newly redrawn districts that would have given the party an edge in winning five more House seats. **A5**

Bullying settlement A Virginia private school agreed to pay \$100,000 to a couple who said their child had faced antisemitic taunts. **B13**

THE NATION

A Delaware court ordered a former couple to bid for custody of their goldendoodle. **A8**

Lawmakers in mostly red states want to allow pregnant women to use disability parking. **A9**

THE WORLD

Narendra Modi’s party has cemented its power with a sweeping election win in Bihar state. **A10**

Chinese lenders have backed 2,500 projects across nearly every U.S. state, a report finds. **A13**

THE ECONOMY

The Trump administration’s crackdown on legal immigration is fueling angst among foreign professionals and major companies. **A14**

A 50-year mortgage may seem like a good idea, but it’s really a trap, columnist Michelle Singletary writes. **A14**

STYLE

The viral “bird test” can’t predict much about your relationship, experts say, but it still can be useful. **B1**

SPORTS

Michael Locksley got an endorsement from the administration at Maryland. Next up for his Terps: Michigan. **B7**

THE REGION

An officer shot a man who brandished a weapon in Northeast Washington, officials said. **B13**

FOOD

Evoke the spirit of Thanksgivings past with these favorites from the 1920s through the 1970s, updated for today’s kitchen. **E1**

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